

Guglielmo Marconi

The inventor of the first **RADIO SYSTEM**
who received the Nobel Prize in Physics

All about me

- **BORN:** 1874
- **DIED:** 1937
- **NATIONALITY:** Italian
- **FACTOID:** I was an engineer and physicist.
- **IN A NUTSHELL:** Born in Bologna, Italy, I was a bad student, but was fascinated with science and electricity.

The radio star

As a young man, Marconi read about Heinrich Hertz's **discovery of radio waves**. He wondered if you could use radio waves to transmit information without using wires. He started experimenting, and could soon operate a bell wirelessly. His **first long-distance transmission** was in 1896, when he sent a message to a receiver 1 mile (1.6 km) away. In 1897, he started the **MARCONI COMPANY**.

When the radio stations started transmitting sound, Marconi's company started building radio sets.

Early radio systems sent messages using a series of dots and dashes called Morse code.

By the way...
when I died at age 63, radio stations all over the world observed a two-minute silence as a tribute.

Titanic achievement

Seeing its potential, the British and Indian navies adopted Marconi's **wireless telegraph system**, and, by 1901, he was able to send messages across the Atlantic. Marconi's radio proved its worth in 1912 onboard the **TITANIC**. As the ship sank, its radio operators signaled for help. Two ships heard the distress call and came to its aid, **saving 700 lives**.